

**Virtual clinical trials**

Researchers are using technology in innovative ways to make sure that the work on clinical trials continues. <https://digit.in/aug20-35>

**Tech for the pandemic**

From hands free door openers to wrist mounted disinfectants, check out more hacks for the new normal. <https://digit.in/aug20-36>



Tech for the New Normal

Make way for innovative gadgets that help people cope with the 'new normal'

Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in

T

he use of technology to combat the ill effects of COVID-19 are well-documented.

From contact tracing apps to 3D printing PPE kits, there are an array of new and repurposed technologies that are helping combat COVID-19. The novel coronavirus is spreading at a rapid rate in our country presently, and will likely continue to do so for a while. There's an indisputable need for people to adjust to the 'new normal' a.k.a. living life as best one can alongside the raging pandemic and adopting practices that will lower the chance of infection. Therefore, there's a need for products that help people get acclimated to the new normal by

promoting hygiene, social distancing, cleaning and disinfecting measures. There are various companies that are inventing such tech gadgets that help people adjust to the pandemic-induced 'new normal' way of life.

COROHOOK

The novel coronavirus can be transmitted by inhaling airborne respiratory droplets, but it can also be contracted by touching contaminated surfaces and then touching your nose, mouth or eyes. Corohook is a simple but robust hook that can be used to pull shopping carts, lift grocery baskets, pull open doors, lift up garbage bin lids, press elevator buttons, and even type in your PIN at an ATM. The company

claims that the hook is strong enough to lift up to 10 kilograms of weight. This allows you to perform day-to-day tasks outdoors without having to touch potentially contaminated surfaces.

Corohook is made out of an 'antimicrobial' plastic that makes it relatively resistive to germs. However, we urge you to take that with a pinch of salt and wash the hook with soap water thoroughly after every use. The company has also come out with a smaller version called the Corohook Mini Touch that is made up of metal and also has a rubberised tip that can be used as a stylus for your smartphone.

IMMUTOUCH WRISTBAND

A startup called Slightly Robot redesigned an already-existing wristband in their product lineup to suit the needs of people during the pandemic. The redesigned wristband dubbed 'Immutouch' vibrates every time you touch your face. It utilises an inbuilt accelerometer to track when the wearer goes to touch his/her eyes, nose or mouth and vibrates every time the wearer does that. This makes the wearer more

